

1770–1789

SIMPLER
STYLING

Both England and France were instrumental in establishing the look of fashion, which was then taken up by the rest of Europe, and further afield. French fashions were elegant, while English dress was more informal. By the 1770s the collarless coat with bulky side pleats, fashionable since the 17th century, had been replaced by the frock coat, derived from the informal garment worn by English men in the country. There was also a growing informality in women's dress in both England and France, with floating and draped styles of newly available cotton fabrics from the East becoming popular.



Tailored coat Britain was known for immaculate tailoring and the finest wool cloth. The double-breasted style and cut-away skirts of this navy blue wool coat heralded the era of Beau Brummell and dandyism in the early 19th century.



Chemise Fashionable in the 1780s, this garment was the forerunner of later neoclassical dress. The style, a tube of cotton muslin with a drawstring at the neck and sash at the waist, grew popular throughout Europe.

1755

Buff breeches, gathered at the back



Country dress Self-coloured wool outer garments worn with linen shirts, and white silk or cotton knitted stockings were typical English country wear in the mid-18th century. This trend for less formal dress would soon inspire fashions throughout the rest of Europe.

"The Maid from Bath" A play was written about the beautiful young soprano Elizabeth Linley, the most famous woman in England in the 1770s. She was painted in the very latest fashions.

